# "I'll never be respected at work."

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## Where it often comes from

Being overlooked, interrupted, or passed over, or being the youngest, newest, or quietest person in a room, can leave us feeling invisible. A history of being dismissed at home or school makes it easier to read workplace slights as permanent verdicts.

## What Scripture teaches

Proverbs says, "Do you see a man skilled in his work? He will be stationed in the presence of kings." Paul told Timothy, "Let no one despise your youth, but set an example for the believers in speech, in conduct, in love, in faith, in purity." Of Daniel it says, "by his extraordinary spirit, Daniel distinguished himself," and Peter writes, "Conduct yourselves with such honor among the Gentiles that, though they slander you as evildoers, they may see your good deeds and glorify God on the day He visits us." Respect often grows from consistent character and competence over time. It is not instant, and we do not control it, but we can build a reputation that speaks.

> *"Do you see a man skilled in his work? He will be stationed in the presence of kings; he will not stand before obscure men"* (Proverbs 22:29).

## Also see

> "Let no one despise your youth, but set an example for the believers in speech, in conduct, in love, in faith, in purity" (1 Timothy 4:12).

> "Soon, by his extraordinary spirit, Daniel distinguished himself among the administrators and satraps. So the king planned to set him over the whole kingdom" (Daniel 6:3).

> "Conduct yourselves with such honor among the Gentiles that, though they slander you as evildoers, they may see your good deeds and glorify God on the day He visits us" (1 Peter 2:12).

> "In the same way, let your light shine before men, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in heaven" (Matthew 5:16).

## Common self-statements

- No one takes me seriously.
- They talk over me.
- I am invisible here.
- I will always be the junior one.
- My ideas do not count.
- They will never see my value.

## Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting permanent disrespect.
- Mental filter: Remembering slights and forgetting respect.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling dismissed and concluding I am.
- Labeling: Calling myself "invisible."

## Challenging questions

- Which specific incidents make me feel disrespected, and which people respect me?
- Is my feeling about the whole workplace or about a few people?
- How have I handled the moments when I was overlooked?
- What strengths could I make more visible?
- What does Scripture say about character and reputation?
- What is one small step toward being heard?

## Truth summary

> Respect is often built over time through consistent character and good work. I do not control how others treat me, but I can speak up, show competence, and leave my reputation to grow. My worth does not depend on any one coworker's opinion.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Occupation/Job/Work
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride
- Humility
- Wisdom

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Unemployment
- Self-Esteem, Low

## Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

## Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

# My Plan for Replacing "I'll never be respected at work"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"I'll never be respected at work." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What incidents hurt?
- ☐ Who respects me?
- ☐ What strengths can I show?
- ☐ What will I say in the next meeting?
- ☐ What have I done well?
- ☐ Who can be an ally?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ Skilled work stands out.
- ☐ My character can set an example.
- ☐ Daniel distinguished himself over time.
- ☐ My worth comes from God.
- ☐ I can speak up with calm confidence.
- ☐ Respect can grow.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ **Proverbs 22:29**
  *"Do you see a man skilled in his work? He will be stationed in the presence of kings; he will not stand before obscure men."*
- ☐ **1 Timothy 4:12**
  *"Let no one despise your youth, but set an example for the believers in speech, in conduct, in love, in faith, in purity."*
- ☐ **Matthew 5:16**
  *"In the same way, let your light shine before men, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in heaven."*

A verse I found myself: _____

# Practicing the Truth

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## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] A moment of respect: Each week, note one moment of respect or one time you spoke up.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, Proverbs 22:29 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Good work and good character speak for themselves over time.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Occupation/Job/Work" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.*

- [ ] List the incidents. Write the facts about times you felt disrespected.
- [ ] Prepare to speak. Before meetings, write one point to contribute.
- [ ] Build a track record. Document projects completed well.
- [ ] Find an ally. Build a relationship with someone who values your work.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll never be respected at work": _____ %  My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | A moment of respect |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll never be respected at work.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, I long to be taken seriously. Help me work with integrity, speak with calm confidence, and rest in Your approval whatever others think. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*